Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer project

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Semester: 5

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer project

1. Introduction :

The Streamlining IT Procurement - Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer project focuses on improving efficiency in the IT procurement process using ServiceNow automation. Currently, the procurement of standard laptops involves manual tasks which leads to delays and oversight in configuration. This project automates the process by using Flow Designer to automatically create a catalog task for the Hardware team whenever a standard laptop request is approved. This ensures prompt configuration and reduces manual overhead.

2. Project Objective :

The main objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow in ServiceNow using Flow Designer for standard laptop procurement.The project aims to:Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.Improve resource utilization within the IT department by optimizing task allocation.Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.Demonstrate the use of Service Catalog and Flow Designer for process automation.

3. Milestone 1 :

Creation of Flow in Flow Designer

This is the core automation part.

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog Task

Steps:

1. Open ServiceNow instance.

2 . Click on All >> Search for Flow Designer

3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.

4. After opening Flow Designer Click on New and select Flow.

5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as "Standard laptop task".

6. Application should be Global.

7. Select Run as "System user" from that choice.

8.Select Protection as None.

9.Click on Submit.

10.Click on Add a Trigger -> Select Trigger as Service Catalog -> Trigger Condition as Created.

11. Under Catalog Item select Standard Laptop catalog item.

12. Now under Actions.

13. Click on Add an action.

14. Select action in that search for "Create Catalog Task" and select that.

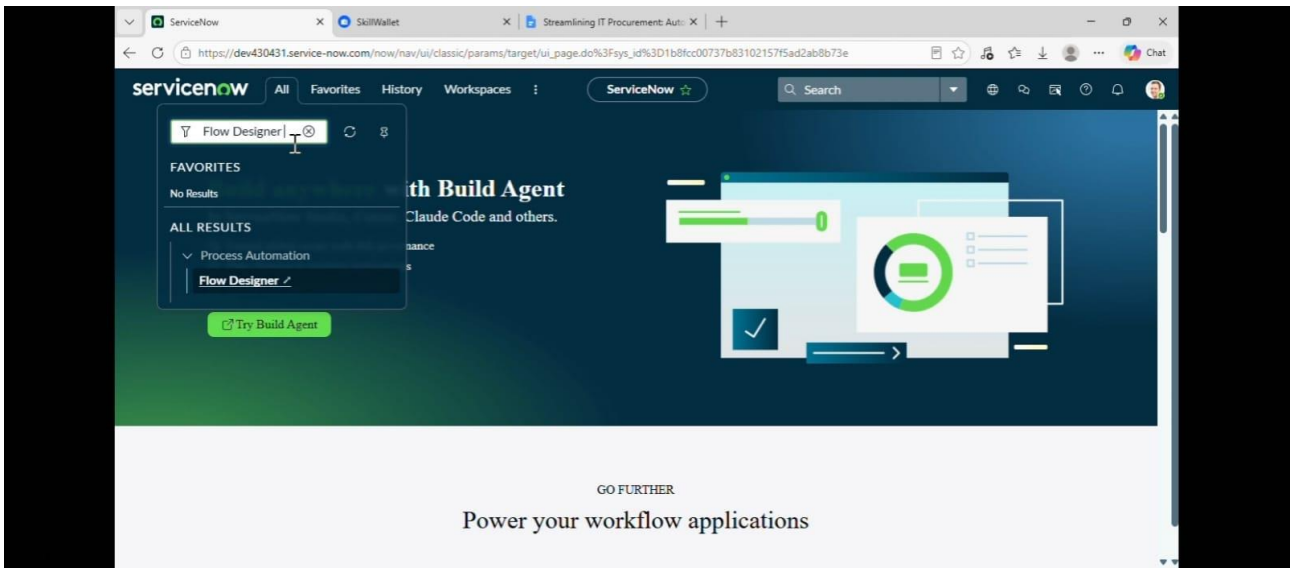
15. Mention these in that action:

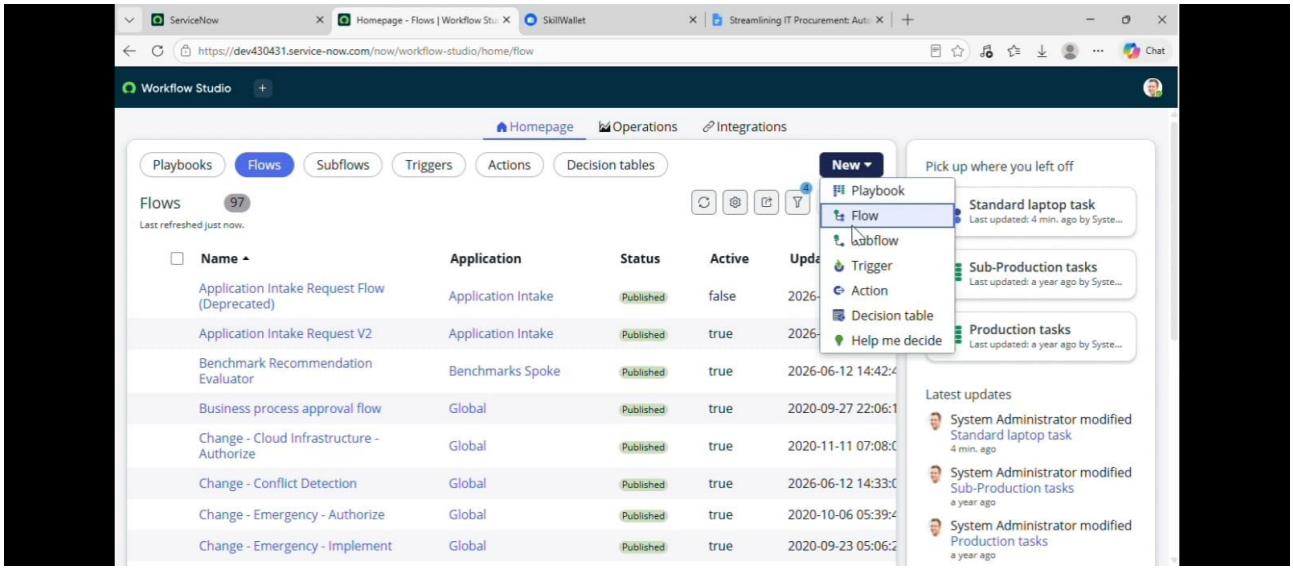
- Action as Create Catalog Task
- Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request Item field.
- Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
- Mention the short description as "Laptop need to Configured".
- Click on Add field value
- Select description field and value as "Laptop need to Configured".
- Select Assignment group field and value as "Hardware".
- Select State field and value as "Open".

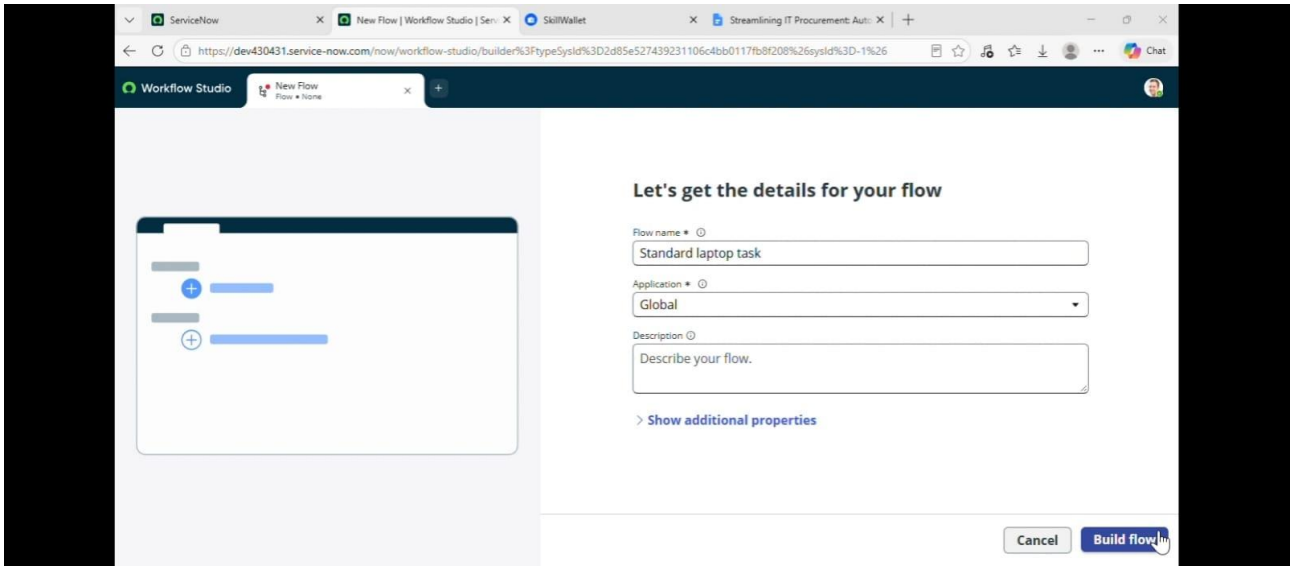
16. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.

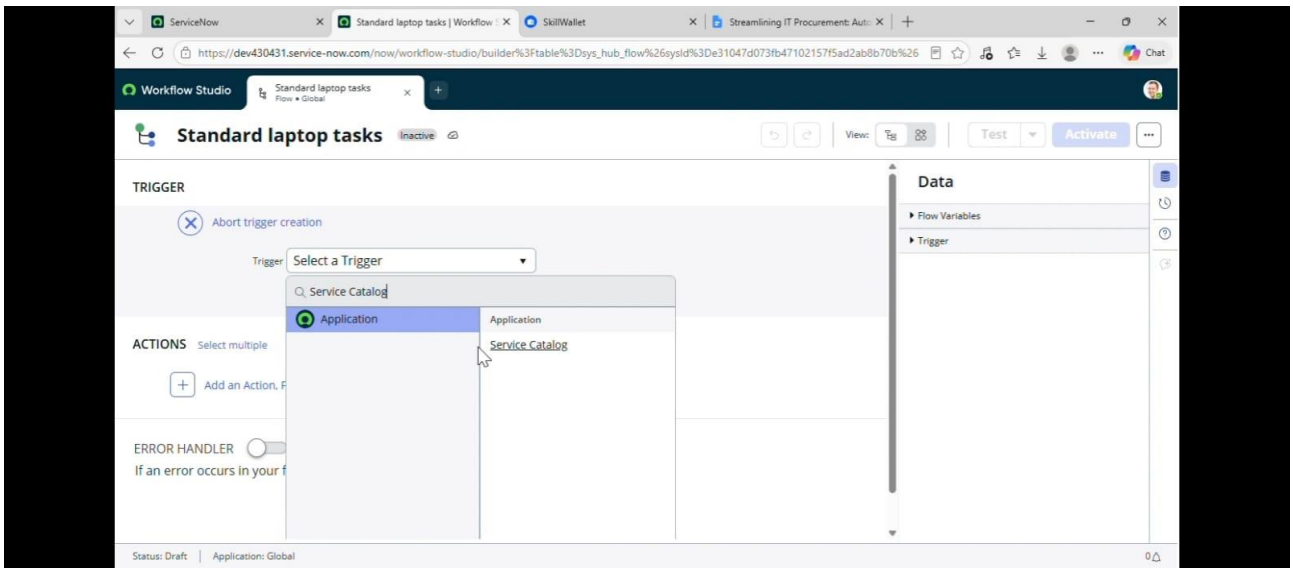
17. Click on Save the Flow.

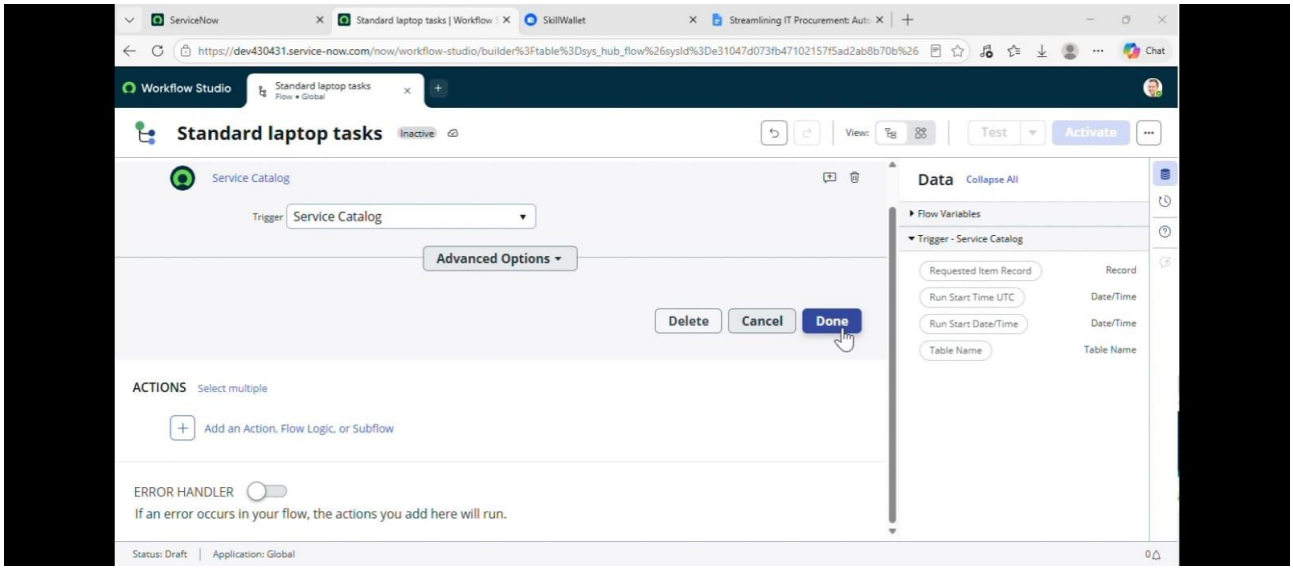
18. And Click on Activate and again click on Activate.

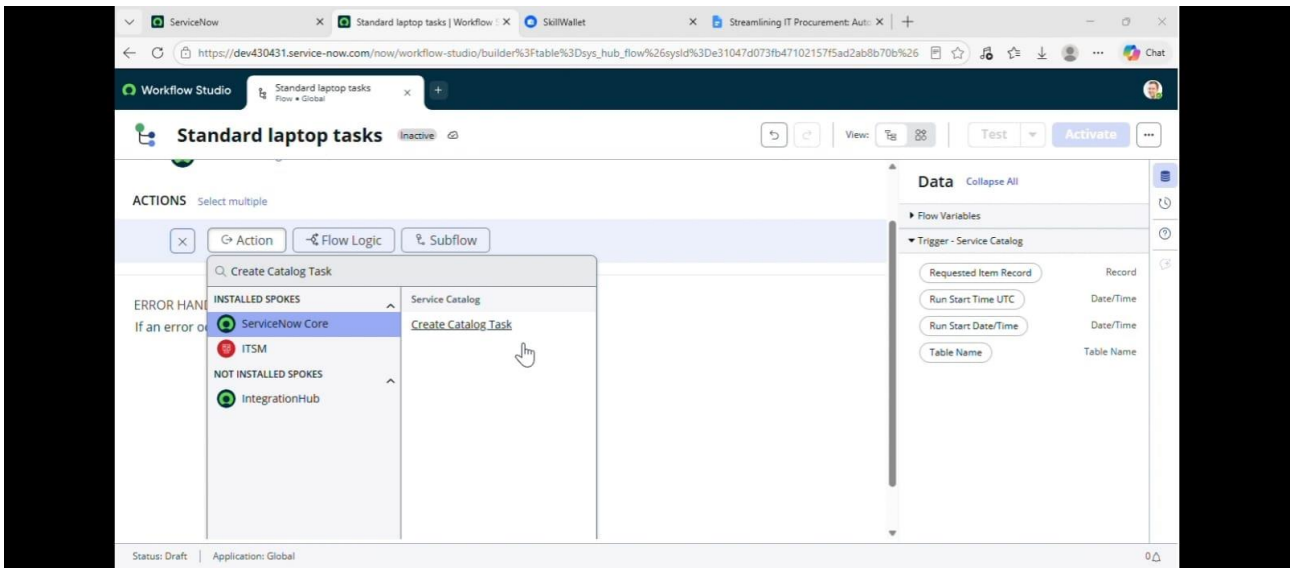

servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Workspaces
ServiceNow
Search
Flow Designer
FAVORITES
No Results
ALL RESULTS
Process Automation
Flow Designer
Try Build Agent
th Build Agent
Claude Code and others.
GO FURTHER
Power your workflow applications

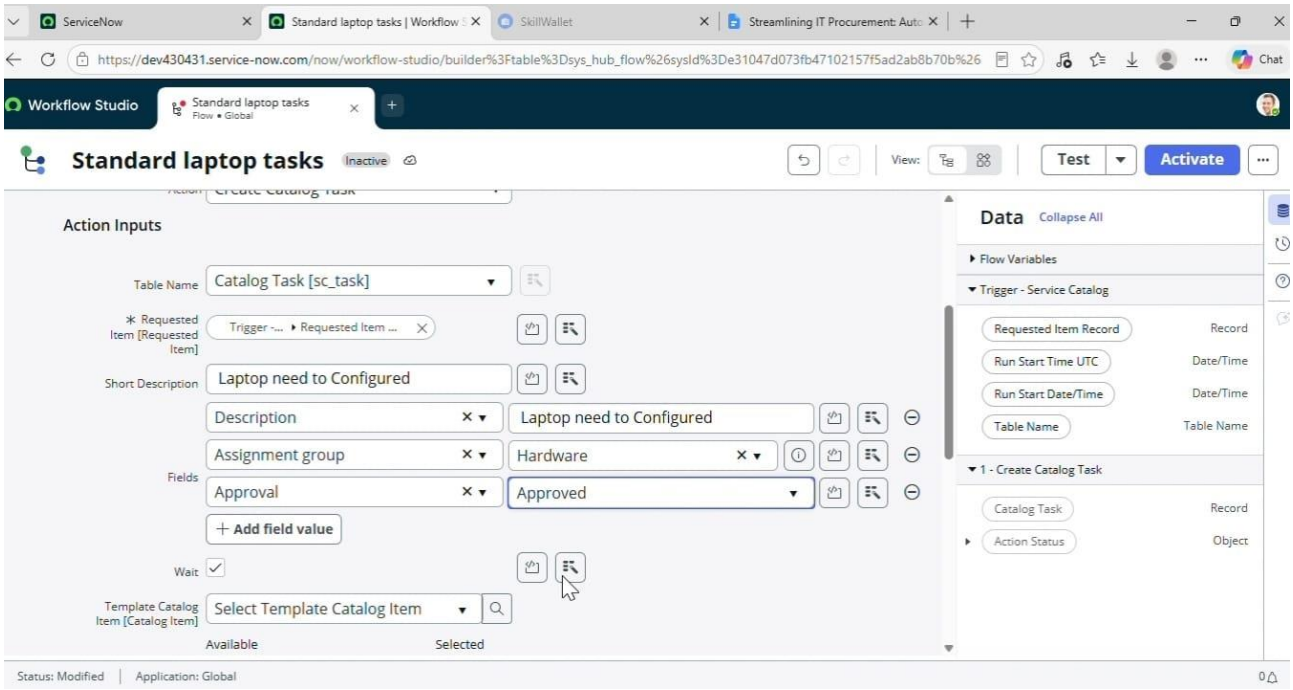

Workflow Studio
Homepage
Operations
Integrations
Playbooks
Flows
Subflows
Triggers
Actions
Decision tables
New
Playbook
Flow
Subflow
Trigger
Action
Decision table
Help me decide
Flows
97
Last refreshed just now.
Name
Application
Status
Active
Application Intake Request Flow (Deprecated)
Application Intake
Published
false
Application Intake Request V2
Application Intake
Published
true
Benchmark Recommendation Evaluator
Benchmarks Spoke
Published
true
Business process approval flow
Global
Published
true
Change - Cloud Infrastructure - Authorize
Global
Published
true
Change - Conflict Detection
Global
Published
true
Change - Emergency - Authorize
Global
Published
true
Change - Emergency - Implement
Global
Published
true
Pick up where you left off
Standard laptop task
Last updated: 4 min. ago by Syste...
Sub-Production tasks
Last updated: a year ago by Syste...
Production tasks
Last updated: a year ago by Syste...
Latest updates
System Administrator modified
Standard laptop task
4 min. ago
System Administrator modified
Sub-Production tasks
a year ago
System Administrator modified
Production tasks
a year ago

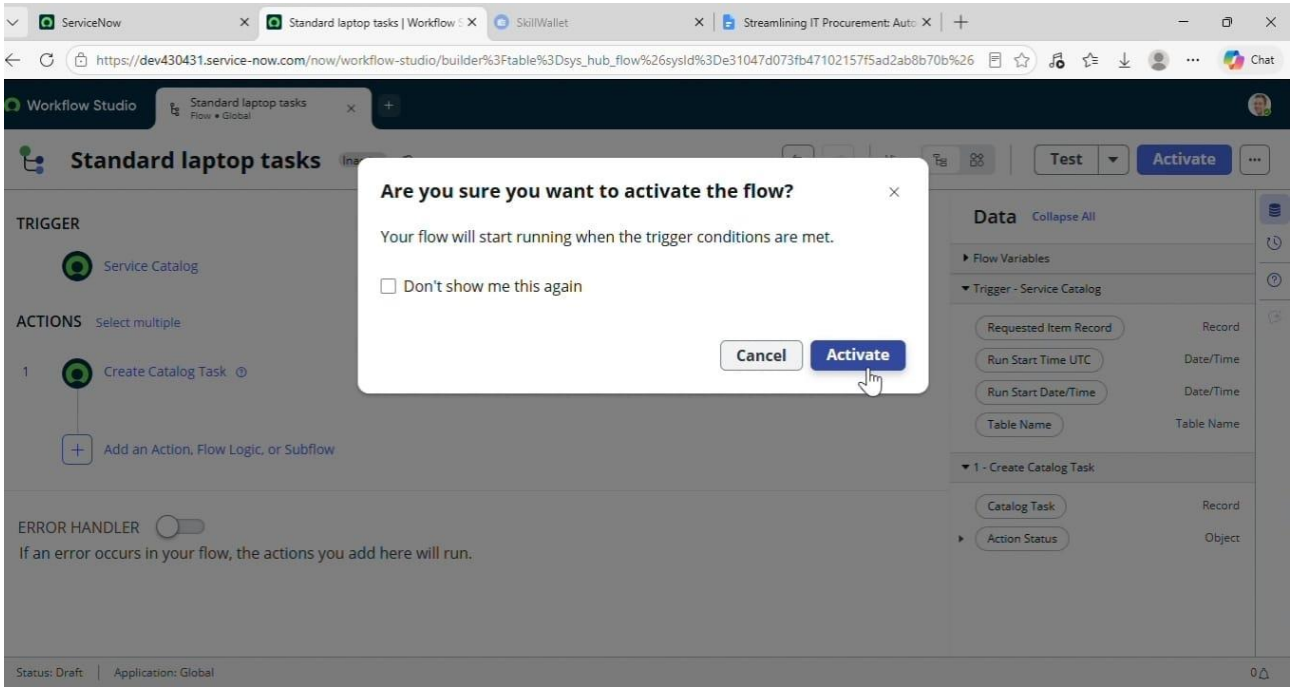

Workflow Studio
New Flow
Let's get the details for your flow
Flow name *
Standard laptop task
Application *
Global
Description
Describe your flow.
Show additional properties
Cancel
Build flow


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
SkillWallet
Streamlining IT Procurement: Auto
https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Inactive
View:
Test
Activate
TRIGGER
Abort trigger creation
Trigger
Select a Trigger
Service Catalog
Application
Application
Service Catalog
ACTIONS
Select multiple
Add an Action, F
ERROR HANDLER
If an error occurs in your f
Data
Flow Variables
Trigger
Status: Draft
Application: Global
0


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
SkillWallet
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Inactive
View:
Test
Activate
Service Catalog
Trigger
Service Catalog
Advanced Options
Delete
Cancel
Done
ACTIONS
Select multiple
Add an Action, Flow Logic, or Subflow
ERROR HANDLER
If an error occurs in your flow, the actions you add here will run.
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
Status: Draft
Application: Global
0


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
SkillWallet
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Inactive
View:
Test
Activate
ACTIONS
Select multiple
Action
Flow Logic
Subflow
Create Catalog Task
INSTALLED SPOKES
ServiceNow Core
ITSM
NOT INSTALLED SPOKES
IntegrationHub
Service Catalog
Create Catalog Task
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
Status: Draft
Application: Global


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
SkillWallet
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/workflow-studio/builder%3Ftable%3Dsys_hub_flow%26sysId%3De31047d073fb47102157f5ad2ab8b70b%26
Chat
Workflow Studio
Standard laptop tasks
Flow • Global
Standard laptop tasks
Inactive
View:
Test
Activate
Action Inputs
Table Name
Catalog Task [sc_task]
* Requested Item [Requested Item]
Trigger -... ▸ Requested Item ...
Short Description
Laptop need to Configured
Fields
Description
Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group
Hardware
Approval
Approved
+ Add field value
Wait
Template Catalog Item [Catalog Item]
Select Template Catalog Item
Available
Selected
Data
Collapse All
Flow Variables
Trigger - Service Catalog
Requested Item Record
Record
Run Start Time UTC
Date/Time
Run Start Date/Time
Date/Time
Table Name
Table Name
1 - Create Catalog Task
Catalog Task
Record
Action Status
Object
Status: Modified
Application: Global

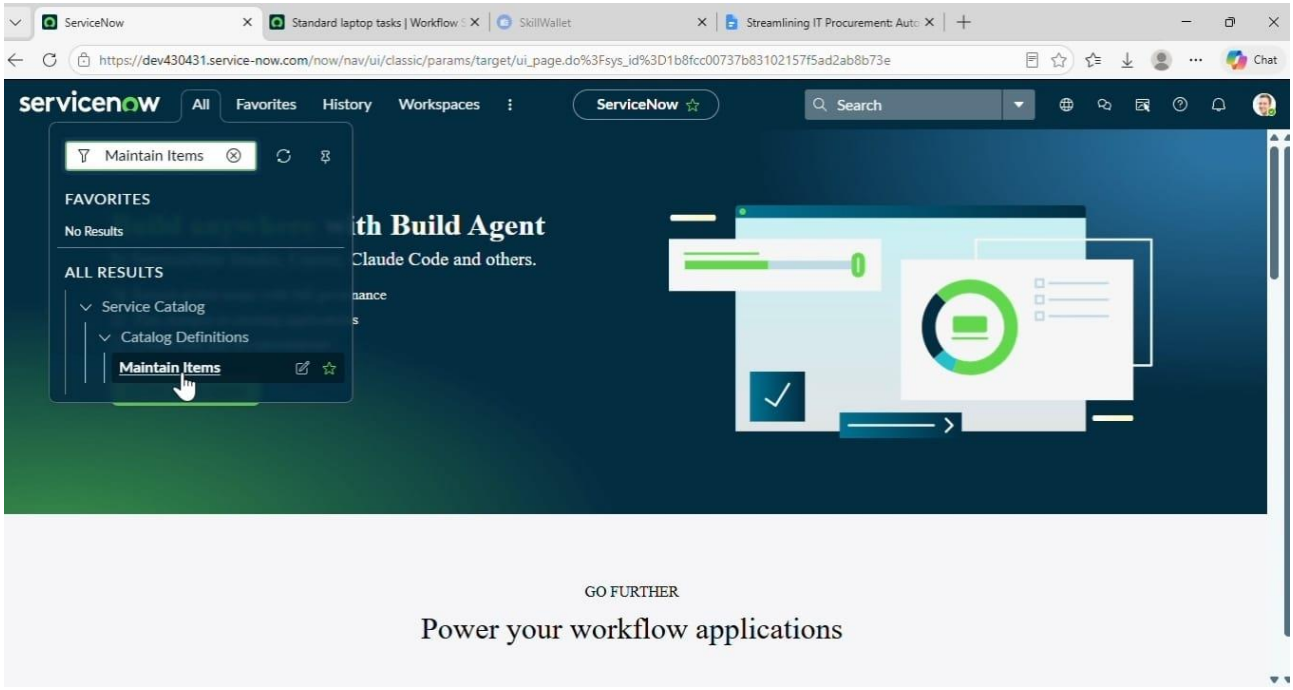


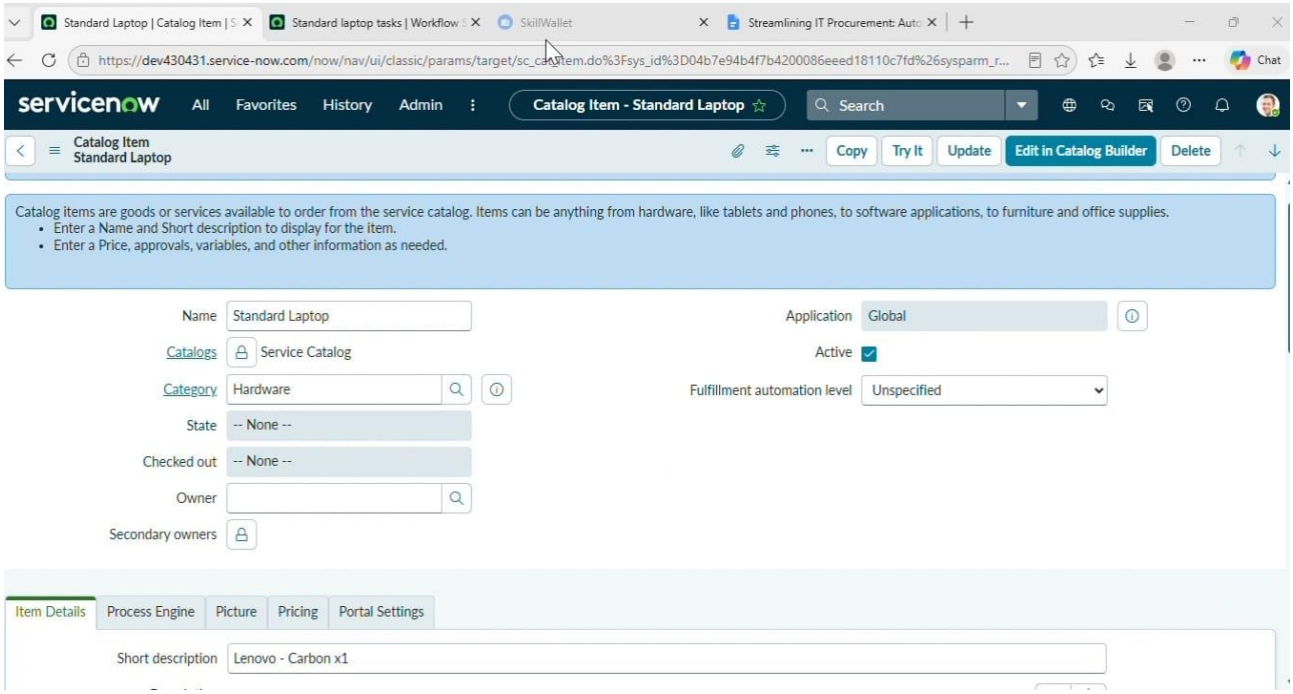
4. Milestone 2 : Flow Assignment to Service Catalog

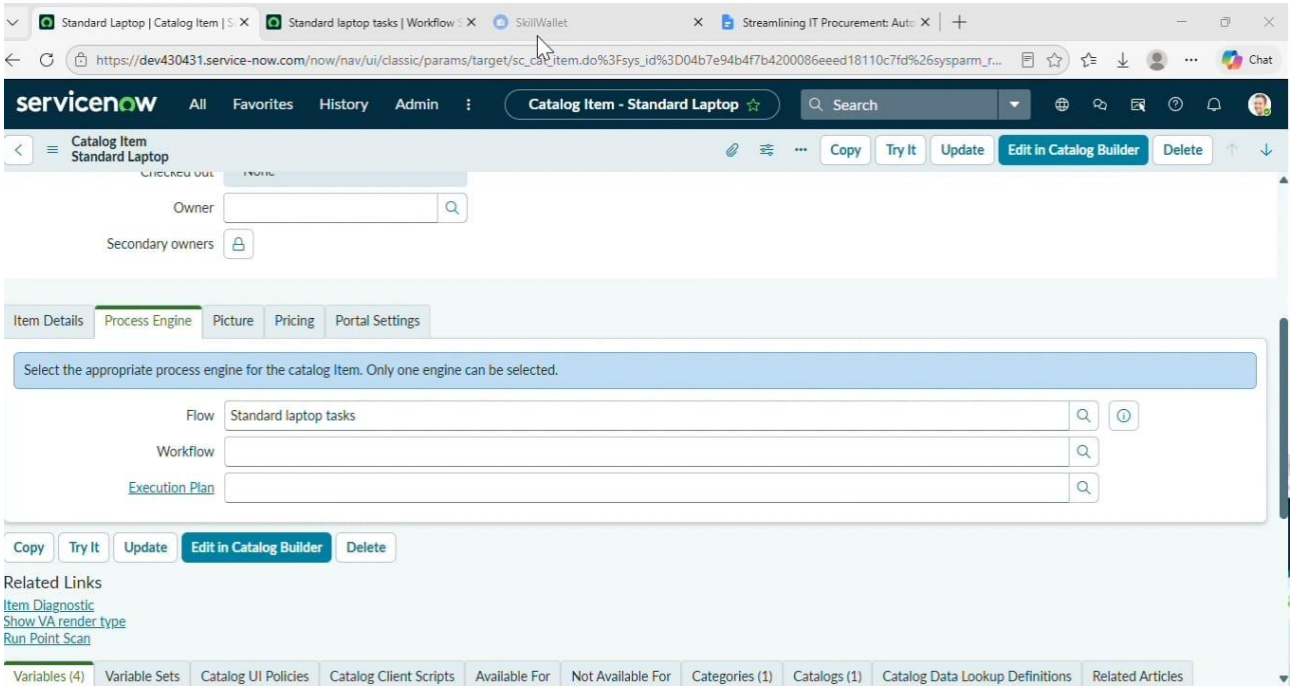
The created flow should be linked to the catalog item.

Activity 1: Assign Flow to Standard Laptop Catalog

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on All >> search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items under Service Catalog.
4. Under the Name field search for "Standard Laptop" and Select that record.
5. Under that record, navigate to Process Engine tab.
6. In the Flow field, remove the remaining automations (like Workflow) and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name "Standard Laptop Task".
8. Click on Update to save the record.


ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/ui_page.do%3Fsys_id%3D1b8fcc00737b83102157f5ad2ab8b73e
Chat
servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Workspaces
ServiceNow
Search
Maintain Items
FAVORITES
No Results
ALL RESULTS
Service Catalog
Catalog Definitions
Maintain Items
th Build Agent
Claude Code and others.
GO FURTHER
Power your workflow applications


Standard Laptop | Catalog Item |
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_cat_item.do%3Fsys_id%3D04b7e94b4f7b4200086eeed18110c7fd%26sysparm_r...
Chat
servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Admin
Catalog Item - Standard Laptop
Search
Catalog Item
Standard Laptop
Copy
Try It
Update
Edit in Catalog Builder
Delete
Catalog items are goods or services available to order from the service catalog. Items can be anything from hardware, like tablets and phones, to software applications, to furniture and office supplies.
Enter a Name and Short description to display for the item.
Enter a Price, approvals, variables, and other information as needed.
Name
Standard Laptop
Application
Global
Catalogs
Service Catalog
Active
Category
Hardware
Fulfillment automation level
Unspecified
State
-- None --
Checked out
-- None --
Owner
Secondary owners
Item Details
Process Engine
Picture
Pricing
Portal Settings
Short description
Lenovo - Carbon x1



5. Milestone 3 : Service Catalog Request and Verification

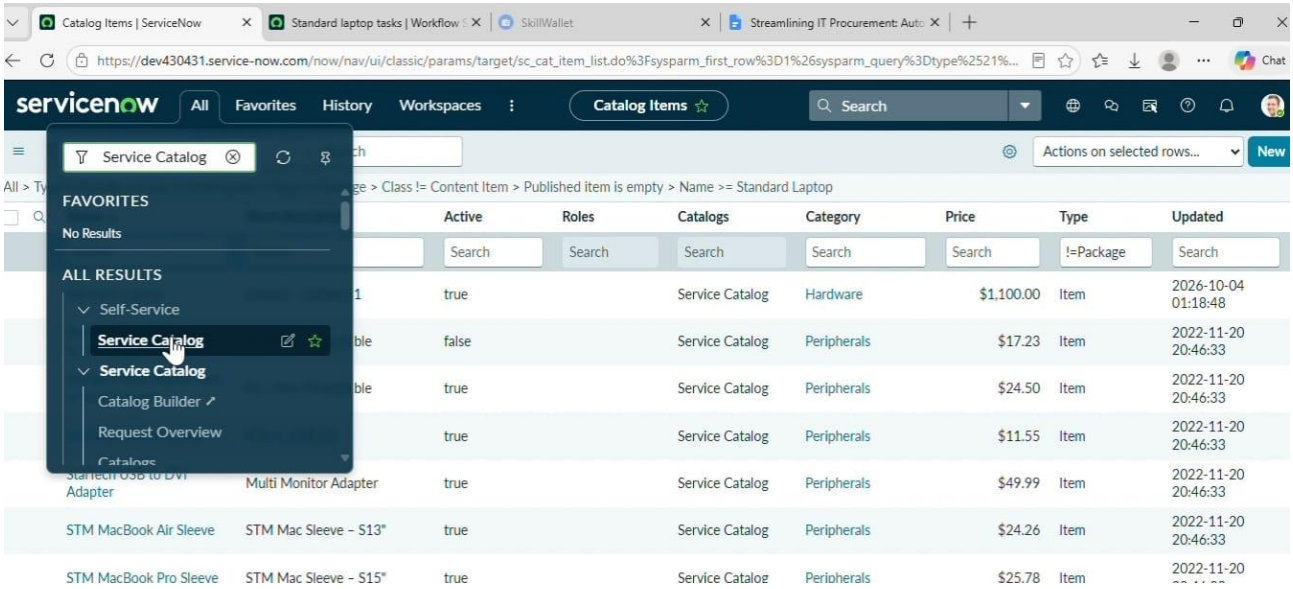
This is to test the flow.

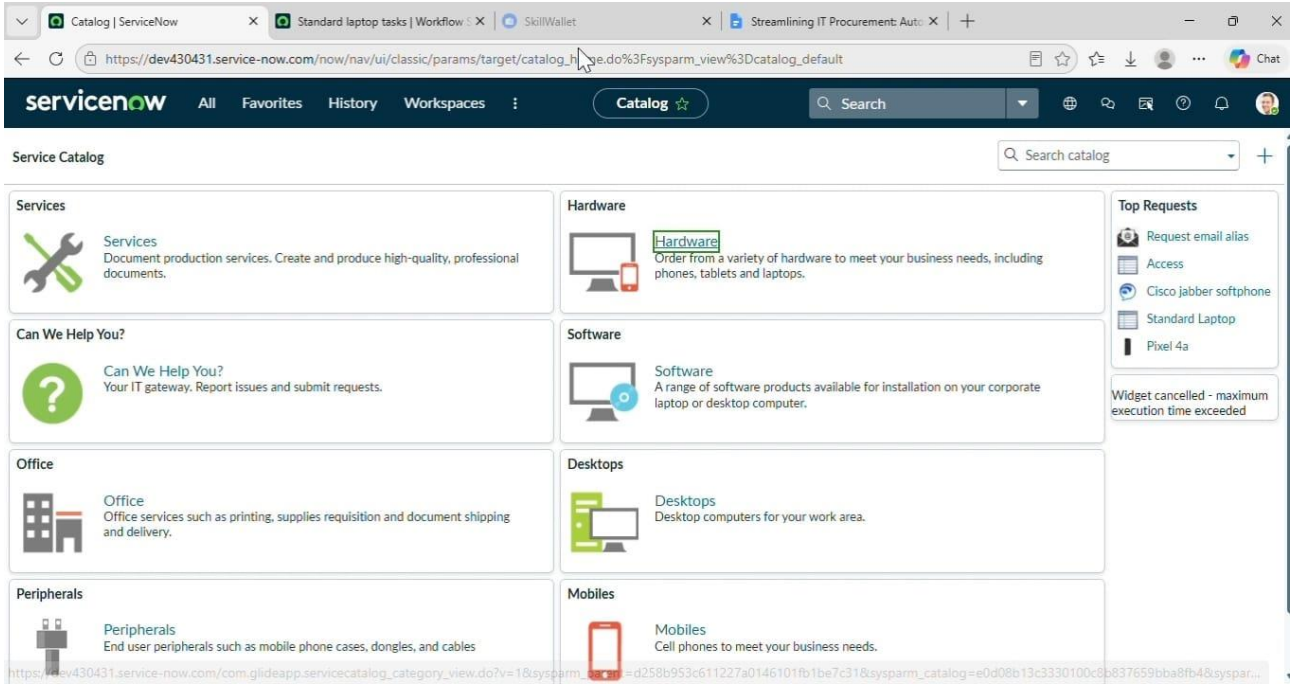
Activity 1: Placing an Order

1. Click on All >> Search for "Service Catalog".
2. Click on Service Catalog >> Click on Can Get Anything? or Search for Hardware category.
3. Scroll a bit to find the "Standard Laptop" catalog item and click on that.
4. After that click on "Order Now" to place the request.
5. Now we will see the Order Status page with Request Number.
6. In that click on the Request Number (REQxxxx).
7. It will open the Requested Item record (RITMxxxx).
8. Scroll down to the "Catalog Tasks" Section.
9. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short Description "Laptop need to Configured" and Assigned group as "Hardware".

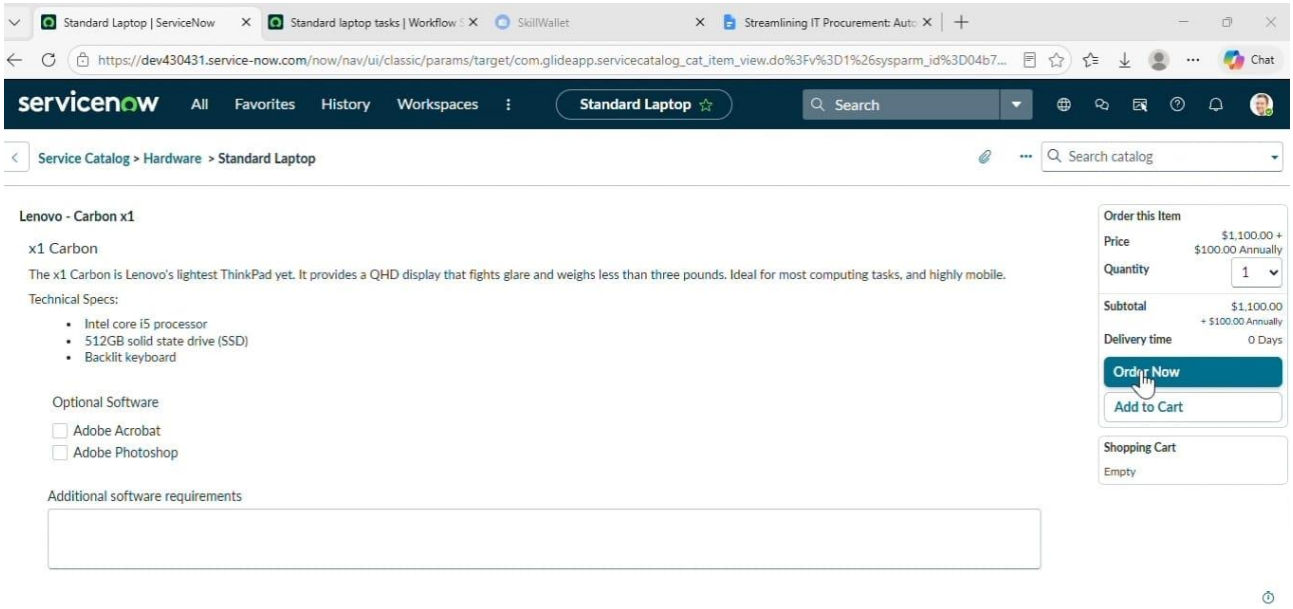
Verification:

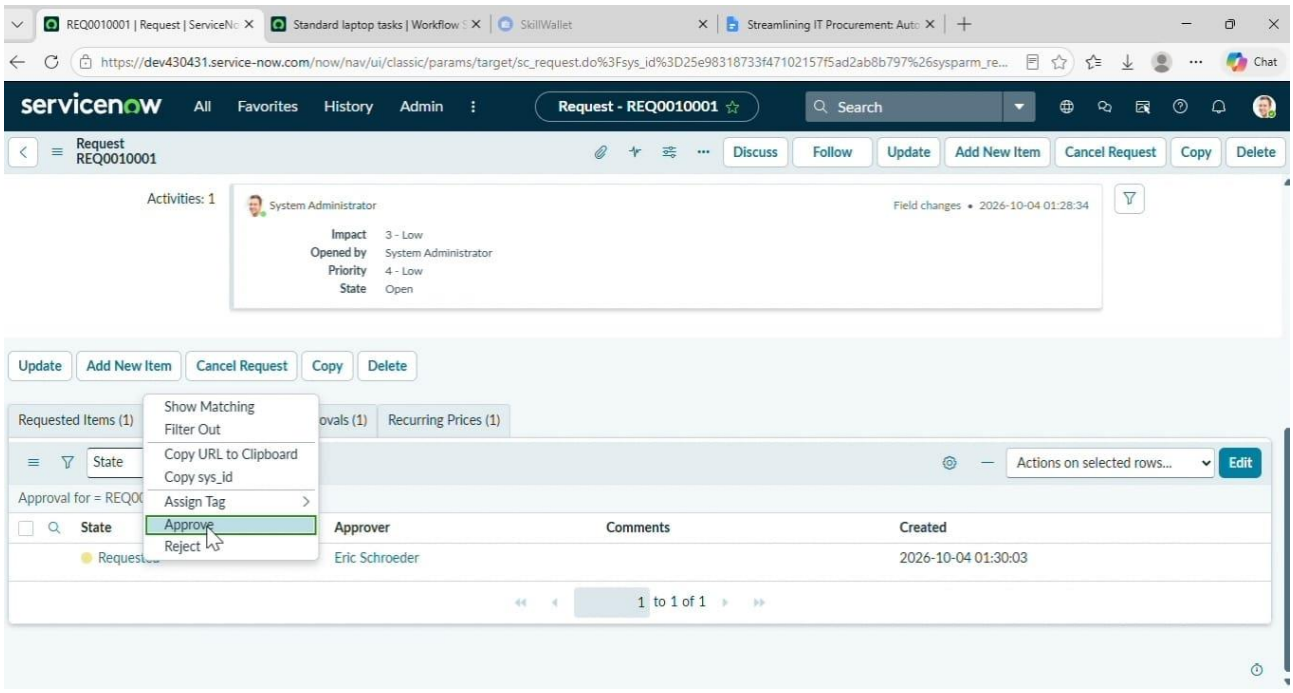
- When a user orders a Standard Laptop, a SC Task is automatically created.
- The task is assigned to Hardware group without any manual intervention.
- The task status is open and ready for hardware team to configure.

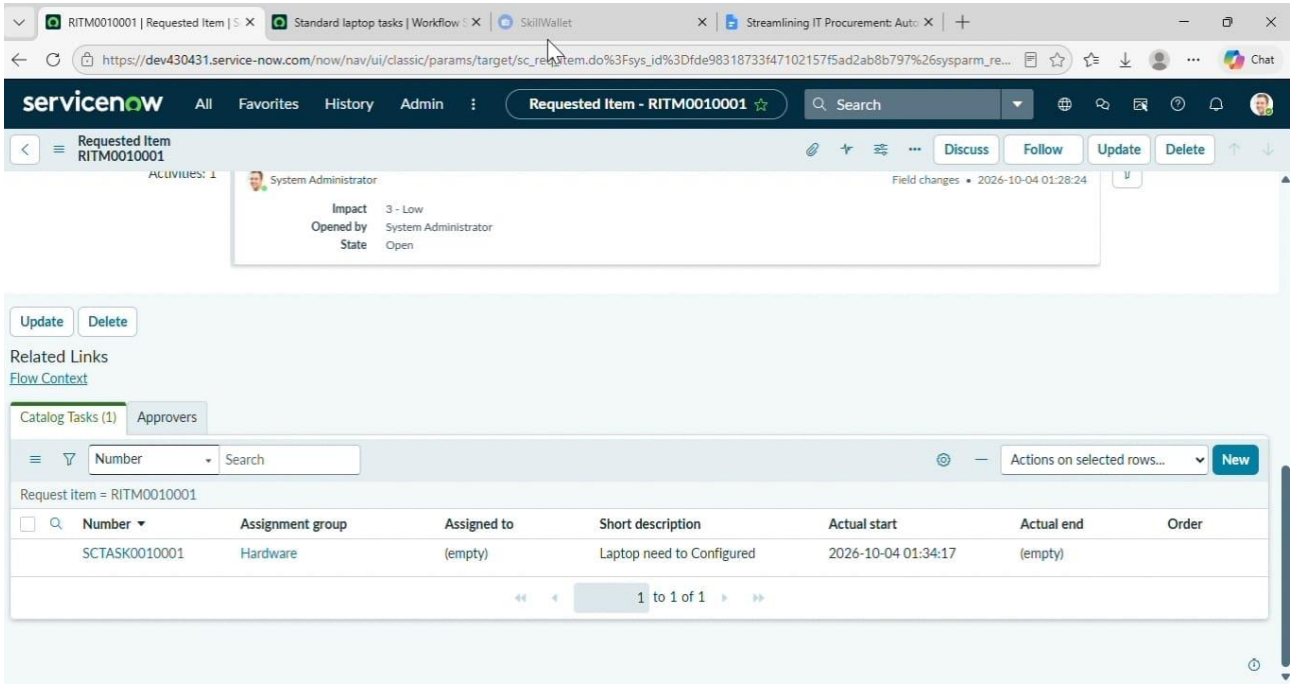


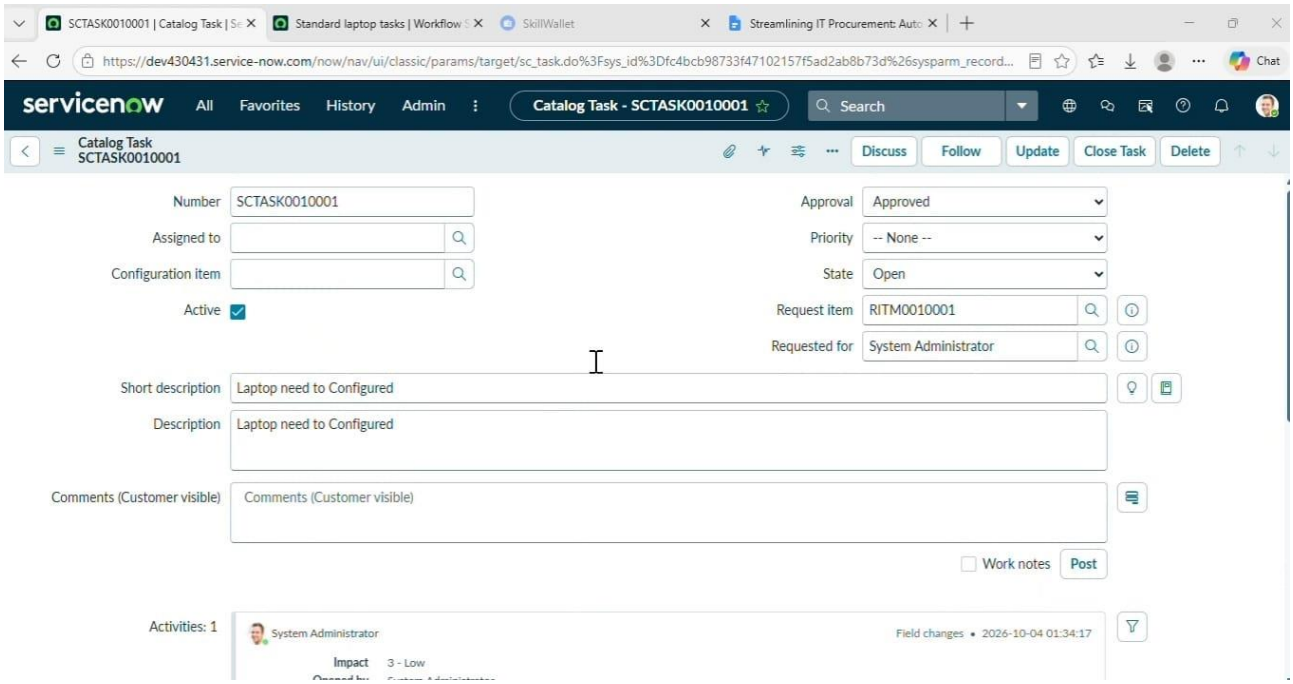


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Standard Laptop | ServiceNow
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
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Chat
servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Workspaces
Standard Laptop
Search
Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop
Search catalog
Lenovo - Carbon x1
x1 Carbon
The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.
Technical Specs:
Intel core i5 processor
512GB solid state drive (SSD)
Backlit keyboard
Optional Software
Adobe Acrobat
Adobe Photoshop
Additional software requirements
Order this Item
Price
$1,100.00 + $100.00 Annually
Quantity
1
Subtotal
$1,100.00 + $100.00 Annually
Delivery time
0 Days
Order Now
Add to Cart
Shopping Cart
Empty


REQ0010001 | Request | ServiceNo
Standard laptop tasks | Workflow
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https://dev430431.service-now.com/now/nav/ui/classic/params/target/sc_request.do%3Fsys_id%3D25e98318733f47102157f5ad2ab8b797%26sysparm_re...
Chat
servicenow
All
Favorites
History
Admin
Request - REQ0010001
Search
Request
REQ0010001
Discuss
Follow
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Activities: 1
System Administrator
Field changes • 2026-10-04 01:28:34
Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
Priority 4 - Low
State Open
Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete
Requested Items (1)
Recurring Prices (1)
Show Matching
Filter Out
Copy URL to Clipboard
Copy sys_id
Assign Tag
Approve
Reject
State
Actions on selected rows...
Edit
Approval for = REQ0
State
Approver
Comments
Created
Eric Schroeder
2026-10-04 01:30:03
1 to 1 of 1





6. Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a

seamless and efficient procurement process. The project provides a practical approach to implementing automation in IT operations within the ServiceNow platform.